

1620

PILGRIM FATHERS

In autumn 1620, a group of English Puritans fleeing religious persecution made a ten-week voyage across the Atlantic on board the *Mayflower*. Of the 102 “pilgrims” who reached Cape Cod in November, fewer than half survived to celebrate Thanksgiving with Indigenous peoples in 1621. They established the Plymouth Colony, the second permanent English settlement in North America.

▷ *Thanksgiving at Plymouth*, Jennie Brownscombe, 1925



1620

1620 Court eunuch Wei Zhongxian begins a reign of terror over Ming China under the ineffectual Tianqi emperor

1623 The Dutch East India Company executes rival traders on Ambon Island, Indonesia

1620 English philosopher Francis Bacon describes a new system of logic in his *Novum Organum*

◁ Michelangelo's plan of St Peter's, 1569



△ Battle of the White Mountain

1620

BATTLE OF THE WHITE MOUNTAIN

In 1619, the Bohemian (Czech) parliament chose the Protestant Elector Palatine Frederick V as their king. The Catholic Holy Roman Emperor Ferdinand II sent a large army to crush Bohemian independence. At the White Mountain outside Prague, Frederick's army was routed. The Catholic faith was brutally imposed on Bohemia but conflict between Protestants and Catholics continued as the Thirty Years' War.



1626

ST PETER'S BASILICA COMPLETED

After 120 years under construction, St Peter's Basilica in Rome was completed in November 1626. The world's largest church, it was the work of many architects, from Donato Bramante, who made the original design, through Michelangelo, largely responsible for the vast dome, to Carlo Maderno, who added the façade. A Renaissance masterpiece, the Basilica boldly asserted the power and wealth of the Catholic Church.